Which Wheel to Turn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 18

One wheel opened the speaking tube. The other opened a small shelf shutter. Nib turned the prettier wheel and found himself looking at an unrelated panel. Lark closed it gently and held the borrower's note beside the actual tube bracket.

“Which wheel is wonderfully round?” Nib wondered aloud. “Which wheel opens our tube?” Lark asked patiently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **gem**

“Wh begins when and wheel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Some families say it like w, and some keep a breathier sound. We'll use the way we speak. Why has the final y sound we already know. Read the examples without inventing an extra syllable.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try when, wheel, why. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read wheel on the note,” Lark invited gently. “Which pictured wheel opens the tube where we are meant to listen?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **When can I turn the wheel? The note has it.**

“What can answer the speaker's question?” Lark asked gently. “Find it in the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib turned the correct wheel. The ordinary tube carried the waiting borrower's message clearly. Lark read back the confirmed request: Phone, the illustrated story of woodland messages. The book shelf stayed closed until that confirmation was complete. No fifth request had appeared.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write wheel beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the confirmed borrower. The steady reading rest was ready, the receipt cell was prepared, and one requested book remained to be selected by its actual title.